

Positive Patterns for AdriaticGo

1. Remove roadblocks

A leader's job is to clear the path so the engineering team can focus entirely on technical execution without interruptions.

Implementation in AdriaticGo: The project has a very tight timeline with a hard deadline of 1 June 2026. During Phase 2 (Core Development), the team will be busy building the application. The project lead must proactively ensure that third-party accounts (like cloud hosting and payment gateway providers) are approved, funded from the €80,000 budget, and accessible before the developers actually need them. If a cloud service goes down or a payment API key is delayed, the leader must step in immediately to solve it.

2. Set clear goals

Providing the team with unambiguous targets so everyone knows exactly what the team's goal and priorities are.

Implementation in AdriaticGo: The project scope is strictly limited to Koper and excludes advanced logistics or broad marketing. The leader must enforce these boundaries. By setting clear goals tied to the delivery plan, such as that by the end of March, the system architecture design fully documented, so the team stays aligned. This prevents scope creep and ensures the MVP meets the core requirement of supporting the four user roles (customers, restaurants, couriers, admins) without getting distracted by unnecessary features.

3. Be a teacher and a mentor

Fostering an environment of continuous learning and mutual support rather than just giving orders.

Implementation in AdriaticGo: Since the platform requires strict GDPR compliance and encrypted data transmission, team members with more experience in cybersecurity should actively mentor the others during Phase 3 (Integration and Testing). Utilizing advanced techniques during the security and performance testing phase will elevate the whole team's skill set and reduce the risk of critical security vulnerabilities.

Negative Patterns (Anti-Patterns) to Avoid

1. Micromanagement (The "Dictator" Pattern)

Dictating exactly how a task should be done rather than explaining what needs to be accomplished, stripping the engineering team of their autonomy.

Implementation (How to avoid it in AdriaticGo): Having a capable development team of five, instead of the leader designing the database schema and forcing the team to type it out, the leader should assign the objective. Trust the internal development team's expertise to make the right architectural choices during Phase 1, intervening only if the design threatens the €80,000 budget cap or the timeline.

2. Ignoring Technical Debt (The "Feature Factory" Pattern)

Prioritizing speed and new features over code quality, leading to a fragile, unmaintainable codebase.

Implementation (How to avoid it in AdriaticGo): The pressure to deliver the MVP by 1 June 2026 is high, which naturally introduces the risk of development delays. A poor leader would force the team to skip Phase 3 (Testing) to launch faster. To avoid this negative pattern, the leadership must protect the schedule allocated for Phase 3. No matter how much pressure there is to launch the pilot, functional, security, and performance testing must be completed to prevent the platform from crashing when real restaurants and couriers start using it.